

shows the direction in which I was heading; note especially the last sentence, which has always been in bold type, and most especially the term ‘demonstrated’.¹ For example, my critical apparatus for Revelation gives the evidence in terms of Hoskier’s nine groups, rather than percentages of MSS.

Nonetheless, in 2003, Wipf and Stock Publishers published *The Identity of the New Testament Text II*, as an academic reprint. It contained further revision, but it still used Burgon’s ‘Notes of Truth’, although I introduced a Family 18, that I soon changed to Family 35. By 2002 I had become aware of Family 35, but my development of a theory surrounding it was still tentative and incomplete. By the time Wipf and Stock published *The Identity of the New Testament Text III* in 2012, I had done sufficient work on that theory to replace Burgon’s ‘Notes of Truth’ with it.

It was the Hodges-Farstad Majority Text’s representation of the evidence for the *Pericope Adulterae* that caught my attention, being based on von Soden’s supposed collation of over 900 MSS.² As stated in their apparatus, there were three main streams: **M**⁵, **M**⁶ and **M**⁷. **7** was always in the majority [except for one five-way split where there is no majority] because it was always accompanied by either **5** or **6** [**5** + **6** never go against **7**]. This looked to me like three independent streams, where seldom would more than one go astray at any given point. Being the common denominator, **7** was clearly the best of the three, and presumably also the oldest.

Then I went to Revelation (in H-F) and noticed three main streams again: **M**^{a-b}, **M**^c and **M**^{d-e}. The picture was analogous to that of the *PA*. Revelation represents a very much larger corpus than does the *PA*, but even so, there are only 8 cases where **a-b** and **d-e** join against **c** (+ 6 others where one of the four is split), compared to over 100 each for **a-b** and **c** against **d-e** and for **c** and **d-e** against **a-b**. Again, being the common denominator, **c** was clearly the best of the three (see the apparatus of my Greek Text of the Apocalypse).

Now then, it so happens that **M**⁷ in the *PA* and **M**^c in Revelation equal Soden’s **K**^r, so I began to smell a rat.³ Then the *Text und Textwert* series proved that **K**^r is independent of **K**^x throughout the NT. It follows that **K**^r cannot be a revision of **K**^x. Then there are hundreds of places where **K**^r

¹ Hort did the discipline a considerable disservice by positing theoretical text-types, devoid of evidence, and then treating them as established fact.

² Robinson’s collations show that Soden ‘regularized’ the data.

³ Why ‘smelled a rat’? Because **M**⁷ is clearly older than **M**⁵ and **M**⁶ in the *PA*, and **M**^c than **M**^{a-b} and **M**^{d-e} in Revelation, but von Soden claimed **K**^r was a revision of **K**^x (how could it be a revision if it was older?).